infighting that could undermine rebuilding efforts. Senior MLA Basangouda Patil Yatnal was expelled last year after his relentless public attacks on BSY and Vijayendra.

The absence of a clear post-Yediyurappa consensus, combined with concerns over the upcoming Bengaluru municipal elections and the erosion of the party's Lok Sabha strength in the state, has effectively paralysed decision-making. BJP leaders privately acknowledge that the leadership transition of July 2021—when Bommai, a Vokkaliga, replaced BSY as CM—weakened the party's traditional support base. As the next assembly election approaches in 2028, the leadership is wary of a similar disruption.

THE HARYANA HICCUP

In Haryana, the leadership question revolves around the enduring influence of former CM Manohar Lal Khattar, still one of the most consequential organisation figures in the state unit. Currently a Union minister, his proteges occupy the two top positions now. Nayab Singh Saini succeeded him as chief minister, while Mohan Lal Badoli currently heads the state party organisation.

The debate over the next state unit chief has also been shaped by Khattar's own legacy. His 10-year reign as chief minister left behind a faction-ridden organisation, allege many insiders. The challenge is compounded by the BJP's rapid and somewhat inorganic growth in Haryana in the past decade, and the growing stature of CM Saini, who is developing an independent image quite his own. The party has absorbed several influential leaders from rival formations such as the Congress, Indian National Lok Dal (INLD) and the Jannayak Janta Party (JJP). Prominent figures such as Kiran Chaudhary, Rao Inderjit Singh and Kuldeep Bishnoi may not be contenders for the state chief's post, but they remain important power centres whose views the leadership cannot ignore.

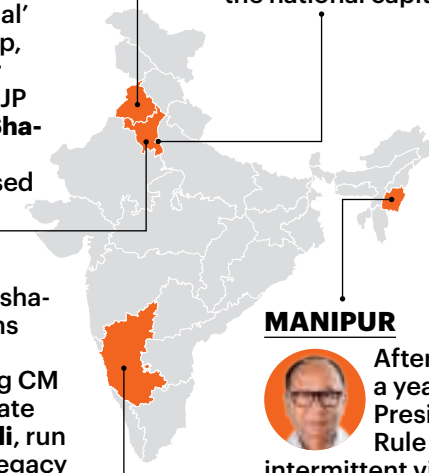
Alongside them stand long-time BJP veterans such as Anil Vij and Ram Kumar Gautam, each representing distinct political constituencies within the party. For now, the delay in appointing a new state unit chief reflects a careful balancing act. The BJP leadership must weigh Khattar's continuing influence, maintain caste and regional equilibrium, and ensure the party organisation retains enough autonomy to engage with public discontent without weakening the government it leads.

PUNJAB PREDICAMENT

If there is one state the BJP appears to be struggling to decode, it is Punjab. The party has been in decline in the state here since the collapse of its long-standing alliance with the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) in 2020. But hope springs eternal; party leaders are excited about a rally in Moga that Amit Shah is scheduled to address on March 14, which they say will "signal a fresh beginning".

The uncertainty has been evident for some time now. Last July, the party appointed veteran leader Ashwani Sharma—a two-time former state president—as working president of the Punjab unit after the experiment with Sunil Jakhar, a high-profile defector from the Congress, failed to deliver. Jakhar soon distanced himself from day-to-day party work, but is still seen doing press conferences and delivering speeches. Sharma,

A COMPLEX CALCULUS



PUNJAB





The break-up with the Akali Dal in 2020 started the slide. Now experiments with a 'dual' leadership, Congress defector **Sunil Jakhar** and BJP veteran **Ashwani Sharma**, is leaving the cadre more confused

HARYANA



Ex-CM Khattar's shadow looms large. His proteges, including CM Nayab Saini and state chief **Mohan Badoli**, run the show, but the legacy of a faction-ridden state unit remains, complicated now by defectors and unruly state satraps



DELHI

The BJP is everywhere, with a 'triple engine' government, but state president **Virendra Sachdeva**, who led the party during the polls, seen as a lightweight with not enough heft for the national capital

MANIPUR

After over a year of President's Rule and intermittent violence, the BJP instals **Yumnam Khemchand Singh** as CM. Situation still fraught with risk



KARNATAKA

Yediyurappa and his son and state unit chief **Vijayendra** on one side, the last BJP CM Basavaraj Bommai and organisation man B.L. Santhosh on the other. Who will prevail?